

Five ways to do the WhatsApp number

What each one costs, what it gets you, and where each one bites.

Our pick is at the top if you'd rather not read the lot.

What we'd recommend

Plan A now, Plan B in a few weeks. Buy a new number through Twilio and get it live — that's exactly what you asked for, about **£45 a month**, and you never touch Facebook.

Then once you've seen it working with real enquiries, put a sticker over the van's QR panel so the van feeds into the app too. That's the bit that actually gets you one inbox instead of two.

A • new number live → watch it for 2–3 weeks → B • restick the QR

1 Oct 2026 Affects every plan below. Replying to someone who messaged you first is **free** today; from 1 October Meta charges about 4p a reply. All the prices here are the after-October ones, so nothing jumps on you later.

The five plans

Costs assume roughly 40 enquiries a week. Tell us if that's well out and we'll redo them.

A **New number, van stays on Dan's phone** **START HERE**

~£45/mo

Exactly what you asked for. New WhatsApp number through Twilio, wired into the app. The van's QR keeps going to the old number on Dan's phone, untouched.

WORKS WELL BECAUSE

- Nothing touches the number painted on the van — no risk at all
- Live in days, not weeks
- No porting, no waiting on Lycamobile
- You never open Facebook
- Cheapest of the lot

THE CATCH

- The van QR is your biggest lead source, and those leads stay in Dan's personal WhatsApp
- Two inboxes again — the thing the Lead Centre was built to fix
- Nobody can pick up a lead when Dan's away, and there's no shared history
- So on its own, it only half solves the problem

B **New number, and restick the van's QR to it** **WHERE WE'D END UP**

~£45/mo + stickers

Same as A, then a sticker over the QR panel pointing at the new number. Everything ends up in one inbox without touching your printed phone number.

WORKS WELL BECAUSE

- One inbox, properly — which was the whole point
- Still no porting and no Facebook
- A sticker on one panel is cheap next to a re-signwrite
- The old number stays alive on Dan's phone as a safety net

THE CATCH

- Leaflets already out in the wild still point at the old number
- So you'd watch both for a while — a few months, realistically
- Small cost and a bit of hassle getting the vans done
- A restickered panel can look patched if it's not done well

C **Same, but through 360dialog instead of Twilio** **ONLY LATER**

~£80/mo

A WhatsApp specialist rather than a general provider. Flat monthly fee per number, and no mark-up on the message charges.

WORKS WELL BECAUSE

- Fee never grows, however many messages you send
- Genuinely cheaper past roughly 8,000 messages a month
- WhatsApp is all they do, so support knows it well

THE CATCH

- Nearly double the cost at the volume you're actually doing
- You'd be paying a subscription for headroom you don't need
- No benefit you'd notice day to day

D Move the van's own number into the app

YOU'VE SAID NO

~£45/mo

What we'd originally discussed: take 07440 517077 off Lycamobile and connect it to a provider, so the QR and the leaflets keep working exactly as printed.

WORKS WELL BECAUSE

- Nothing to reprint or resticker — every leaflet stays correct
- One number, one inbox, from day one
- Tidiest end state of any option
- Doesn't need porting either — a provider can take it as it is

THE CATCH

- Connecting it **wipes access to that number's WhatsApp history** — not recoverable
- Dan loses it from his phone; it lives in the app instead
- A short risky window on your main lead source while it switches
- You've said you'd rather not, which is fair

E Aircall's own WhatsApp add-on

BLOCKED

—

Calls and WhatsApp with one supplier, on one bill, since you're taking Aircall for the phones anyway.

WORKS WELL BECAUSE

- One supplier, one bill, one place to ring when something breaks
- Neatest setup of the five, on paper

THE CATCH

- Needs a **verified** Meta account — company documents submitted to Facebook
- That's precisely the thing you've ruled out, so it's off the table for now
- Worth remembering if you ever change your mind

One question we still need answered

You mentioned the calls will come in on an Aircall number. But the van has **0330 133 9144** printed down the side of it.

Is that number moving across to Aircall, or is this a brand-new Aircall number? If it's new, then the phone number on the van and on the leaflets is wrong from day one — and honestly that's a bigger problem than anything on the WhatsApp side, because it's the number people ring.

Quick answer on that and we can sort the calls properly at the same time.

One thing to say no to

If anyone offers you a WhatsApp setup with *no* Meta involvement at all, it'll be a tool that logs in as a normal user. It breaks WhatsApp's rules and gets numbers banned with no appeal. On the number painted on your van, that would be unrecoverable. The legitimate off-the-shelf providers all deal with Meta for you — that's the difference.

Next steps

- 1 **Tell us which plan** — A is our recommendation, and B soon after. — Sam
- 2 **Answer the 0330 question** above. — Sam
- 3 **We confirm one thing with Twilio** before spending anything. — us
- 4 **We buy and connect the number**, registered to C1 so it's always yours. — us
- 5 **We test it properly** — real message in, real reply out, both on the same customer. — us
- 6 **You have a look**, then decide on the QR sticker. — Sam and Dan

Being straight with you about the numbers

The prices come from Twilio's, 360dialog's and Meta's published rates, so we're confident in those. What we can't tell from their websites is exactly how much of the Facebook side each one handles for you — and since that's the entire point of what you asked for, we'll confirm it on a call before spending a penny. If the answer is "you still have to send documents to Facebook", we move to the next provider and tell you.